

Installing Pycharm

We've detected you're using a Windows machine.

Running into issues? Check this [PyCharm Bugs Handout](#), and if your issue persists, post on our discussion forum or come to Ngoc's office hours or the special PyCharm install session!

In CS 106A, you will be writing your code on your computer using an application called **PyCharm**. PyCharm is what is known as an IDE, or *Integrated Development Environment*, which means that it allows us to edit our code, browse our files, run our programs and debug them, all in the same place. It's one of the most popular Python IDEs in the world, and used extremely commonly in industry. This handout is intended to take you through installing PyCharm on your own computer.

Installing Python

Before you can use PyCharm, you'll need to install a *Python Interpreter*. An interpreter is a program that is capable of reading a **.py** file that you have written, and translating the Python code in that file to instructions that your computer can easily execute. Begin by downloading Python. CS106A requires the use of the newest stable version of Python (currently 3.11), so make sure to follow these instructions even if you think you already have Python installed. To install Python, simply open the downloaded installer file and follow the default instructions. Select the link corresponding to your operating system and download the latest version of **Python 3**:

- [Windows Downloads](#)
- [Windows 32-bit installer](#) (If you're using an older Windows computer, download this file)

Installing Python on Windows

Open the downloaded file. Before installing, there should be an option that says "Add Python VERSION_NUMBER in PATH". **Make sure to check this box**. Then, continue installing normally.